Scalping EA Demo Test Log

Twenty trades on a demo account before a single unit of real money. A scalper lives or dies on execution quality — spread at entry, slippage between the signal and the fill, and how the positions are closed — and almost none of that shows up in a win rate. This log captures the numbers that decide whether the edge is real.

Setup — record this before trade one

Every entry below changes how the results should be read. A test run without these recorded is not comparable to anything, including a second run of the same EA.

EA NAME	VERSION / BUILD	PLATFORM (MT4 / MT5)	SYMBOL
BROKER	ACCOUNT TYPE (STANDARD / RAW / CENT)	STARTING DEMO BALANCE	LEVERAGE
TYPICAL SPREAD OBSERVED	TIMEFRAME	TEST START DATE	TEST END DATE
RISK SETTING USED (% OR FIXED LOTS)	MAX TRADES ALLOWED OPEN	VPS OR HOME MACHINE	CONNECTION DROPS DURING TEST

Why the setup block matters more for a scalper than for a swing EA

A strategy that holds positions for days is barely affected by a half-pip of slippage. A strategy that opens and closes in minutes can have its entire statistical edge consumed by it. The same EA run on a standard account and on a raw-spread account, or run from a home connection instead of a VPS, can produce two different results — not because the logic changed, but because the costs did. Record the conditions so the result is attributable.

Trade log

Fill one row per closed trade. **Session**: A = Asian, L = London, N = New York, O = overlap. **Exit**: TP = target, SL = stop, T = time, S = opposite signal, M = manual intervention, MS = margin stop-out. Record slippage in pips — positive means the fill was worse than the signal price. A manual intervention is a finding, not a failure: write down what prompted it.

#	Date / time	Sess.	Dir	Lots	Entry	Stop	Target	Spread at entry	Slippage	Exit	Pips	P / L	Notes
1													
2													
3													
4													
5													
6													
7													
8													
9													
10													
11													
12													
13													
14													
15													
16													
17													
18													
19													
20													

Floating exposure

The worst moment is what decides survival, and it is almost never one of the twenty closed rows above. Log peak open drawdown separately.

Benchmark for the same window

Without this you cannot tell skill from a favourable week. Record what the market did while the EA traded.

Maximum simultaneous open positions	
Worst floating loss (account currency)	
Worst floating loss (% of balance)	
Margin level at that moment	
Closest approach to stop-out	

Symbol's range over the test	
Trend, range or news-driven	
High-impact news events in window	
Days the EA did not trade	

Summary — work these out from the log, do not estimate them

Total trades closed	
Wins / losses	
Win rate	
Average win (pips)	
Average loss (pips)	
Largest single loss (pips)	

Total slippage cost (pips)	
Total spread paid (pips)	
Gross result before costs	
Net result after costs	
Worst losing streak	
Manual interventions	

Expectancy — the one figure to calculate

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Expectancy per trade = (win rate x average win) - (loss rate x average loss)
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Then subtract the average spread and average slippage. A scalper with a 70% win rate, an average win of 6 pips and an average loss of 12 pips has a positive expectancy on paper and a negative one the moment 2 pips of cost per trade are applied. This is the single most common way a promising scalper turns out not to be one, and the log above is what shows it.

> **Only risk what you can lose.** Trading leveraged instruments carries a high risk of losing money rapidly, and past performance — including any demo result — does not predict future results. A demo account does not reproduce real fills, requotes or emotional pressure. Test on demo, then size the smallest live position you can, and never risk money you cannot afford to lose.

How to read the result — four questions in order

- **Does it survive its own costs?** Compare the gross and net columns. If removing one pip per trade turns a profit into a loss, the edge is smaller than the spread and no amount of tuning will fix the account.
- **Is the win rate hiding the loss size?** A scalper can win seven trades in ten and still lose money. Look at the largest single loss against the average win. If one loss erases eight wins, the strategy is one bad session from a large drawdown.
- **Is the sample big enough to mean anything?** Twenty trades is a floor, not a verdict. It is enough to detect a broken system and not enough to confirm a working one. Continue logging past twenty before drawing a conclusion — and keep the same setup block.
- **How much of the result was the market?** Check the benchmark column. An EA that made money in a clean trend may be untested in the range that follows it.

What disqualifies a test run

- Changing settings part-way through — restart the log and the count.
- Manually closing trades to protect the result, then reporting the result without them.
- Running on a demo with different spreads or execution from the intended live account.
- Reporting a backtest as though it were this log. They answer different questions.

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